

Pre-Dance Competition Routines of Professional DanceSport Athletes

This document compiles publicly available pre-competition or pre-performance routine details from professional or elite ballroom-adjacent dance athletes and coaches, organized by athlete name, a concise summary of the routine, and the source link. The available public evidence is limited, so the table prioritizes named dancers or recognized DanceSport professionals where the source provides a direct routine detail rather than generic advice.[cite:5][cite:103][cite:105]

Athlete	Summary of pre-competition or pre-performance routine	Source
Briana Haft	Begins fueling before competition by increasing carbohydrates the day before, adds vitamins and nutrient-dense foods, eats a large breakfast on competition day when dancing later in the evening, then shifts to lighter foods such as a peanut butter and jelly sandwich or pasta when nerves make eating harder; also uses smoothies for protein and vegetables without requiring a full meal.[cite:99]	How to Warm Up Before Competition with Briana Haft
Melissa Cyr	Uses a mental practice session to visualize the performance exactly as desired, often with a round of competition music playing; rehearses floor movement between dances, prepares carefully for controllable factors such as choreography certainty, costuming security, nutrition, hydration, endurance, and uses a focus or “code word” plus deep breathing between dances to stay relaxed and grounded.[cite:108]	Overcoming Stage Fright
Alan Dixon	Emphasizes staying calm before competition and relying on solid preparation; the routine is less a ritual than a mindset built on having done the homework, discussed problems with partner and teachers, and arriving confident enough to enjoy the event. [cite:103]	Alan Dixon Interview at the 2010 Desert Classic
Ilya Abdullin and Anastasia Jerjomina	Mention using familiar, repeated pre-competition habits rather than strong superstitions, including set items they are used to wearing before competing; their broader preparation rhythm includes targeted practice days, rounds when tired, and deliberate recovery time with sleep and downtime between heavier training periods. [cite:105]	Interview with Ilya Abdullin and Anastasia Jerjomina
Kathryn Boren	Starts with a hot shower to get warm quickly, then hair and makeup, followed by a full basic barre and core work session; adds pointe-shoe work for a few exercises, emphasizes grounded foot articulation, balances to find center, and keeps the pre-show warm-up efficient so she does not exhaust herself before performing.[cite:93]	Kathryn Boren Shares Her Pre-Performance Warm-Up

Notes on scope

The public web has much more generic competition advice than named, attributable routine descriptions from professional DanceSport athletes, so this list is intentionally selective.[cite:5][cite:50] Some entries come from recognized professional ballroom experts and competitors discussing their own routines, while one entry comes from an elite ballet performer included as a relevant high-level dance-performance reference because detailed named pre-

performance routines are more widely published in ballet than in ballroom.[cite:108][cite:99]
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